

AI-Assisted Software Development

Module 1: Getting Started with v0

Mike Burton 17-19 March 2025

What is v0?

v0 is Vercel's AI-powered development tool that:

- Generates UI components and code snippets
- Provides a chat-based interface
- Supports multiple frameworks:
 - React
 - Vue
 - Svelte
 - HTML/CSS

Think of v0 as your:

- Always-on pair programmer
- UI component generator
- Code execution environment
- Technical advisor

Getting Started

Prerequisites

- Vercel account (free signup available)
- Web browser
- Basic understanding of web development

Accessing v0

1. Visit v0.dev
2. Sign in with your Vercel account
3. Start a new chat session

UI/UX Design with V0

V0 workflow:

1. Start with Requirements

```
Design a task management app:  
- Clean, modern interface  
- Mobile-responsive  
- Team collaboration focus
```

2. Add Inspiration

- Reference similar apps
- Include screenshots
- Specify design preferences

3. Iterate Design

- Refine through prompts
- Focus on user experience
- Maintain consistency

UI Design Best Practices with V0

1. Clear Initial Prompts

Create a modern task dashboard with:

- Left sidebar navigation
- Card-based task view
- Status indicators
- Team member avatars

2. Iterative Refinement

Adjust the design to:

- Use more whitespace
- Increase contrast
- Add hover states
- Improve hierarchy

Key Features

UI Generation Blocks

```
# Example prompt
Create a responsive navigation bar with a logo,
links, and a dark mode toggle
```

v0 can generate:

- Client-side UI components
- Responsive layouts
- Interactive elements
- 3D graphics (using react-three-fiber)

Code Execution

- Write and test JavaScript code
- Generate test cases
- Debug functionality
- Immediate preview in browser

Working with Projects

Project Organization

- Create separate projects for different needs
- Upload reference materials
- Add custom instructions
- Maintain context across chats

Best Practices

1. Use clear, specific prompts
2. Organize related components in projects
3. Test generated code thoroughly
4. Review accessibility features

Integration Guide

Installing Components

```
# Using shadcn CLI (for React)
npx shadcn-ui@latest add button
```

Framework-specific Usage

- React: Import as standard components
- Vue: Use in Vue templates
- Svelte: Include in Svelte files
- HTML: Copy and paste generated code

Production Considerations

Security

- Review generated code
- Run security scans (e.g., Snyk)
- Follow framework-specific security guidelines

Accessibility

- Test with screen readers
- Use axe for automated testing
- Verify ARIA attributes
- Run Lighthouse audits

Billing and Resources

Credit System

- Free tier available
- Credits per generation
- Various subscription plans
- Team and enterprise options

Support Resources

- Community forums
- Documentation
- Direct support channels

Best Practices and Tips

1. Start with simple components
2. Iterate on generated code
3. Test thoroughly before deployment
4. Keep projects organized
5. Use version control for generated code

Remember: v0 is a tool to enhance your development workflow, not replace your expertise.